

AI Solutions Architect Defense (w/m/d)

Capgemini Deutschland

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WIE DIESES DOKUMENT AUFGEBAUT IST / HOW THIS DOCUMENT WORKS

Die Erklärungen sind auf Englisch, damit du sie schnell und sicher verstehst. Jeder Satz, den du im Gespräch tatsächlich sagen wirst, steht auf Deutsch in einem grünen Kasten, mit der englischen Übersetzung darunter in kursiv.

Explanations are in English so you absorb them quickly. Every sentence you will actually say is in German in a green box, with the English translation underneath in italics.

01 Self-presentation, 90 seconds

What went wrong in the practice run

- Length. Four to five minutes instead of ninety seconds. In a first interview, that alone can lose the room.
- Order. You started in 2008 and worked forward. The format that works is the reverse: who you are today first, how you got there in one sentence, why you are sitting here last.
- Missing. No Defense, no Carl Hase, no numbers. Your strongest material arrived after minute three, when attention had already dropped.
- Too much. Hobbies, family, client-internal detail. None of it helps you get the role, and the client detail actively hurts you in a defence context.

THE FOUR CHECKPOINTS

Who I am · What I own · What I build · Why I am here.

If you lose the thread mid-answer, these four are the rungs you climb back onto. Learn the structure, not the wording.

SELBSTVORSTELLUNG · SO SAGST DU ES

Ich bin Data und AI Consultant in Berlin und arbeite seit 2023 bei CIMPA, einem Unternehmen von Sopra Steria, in Airbus-Projekten. Ursprünglich komme ich aus Guatemala und bin 2015 für den Master nach Deutschland gekommen. Mein Hintergrund ist Ingenieurwesen, erst Chemieingenieurwesen in Guatemala, dann Umweltingenieurwesen in Lübeck. Über die Forschung bin ich zu den Daten gekommen, und weil ich lieber mit Menschen und Stakeholdern arbeite als im Labor, bin ich über ein Data-Science-Bootcamp in die Beratung gegangen.

Heute habe ich zwei Rollen. Etwa siebzig Prozent meiner Zeit verantworte ich Data Governance auf den Airbus-Datenplattformen: eine Roadmap mit über vierzig Initiativen, dreißig davon umgesetzt, dazu Datenqualitätskampagnen, Governance-Frameworks und Monitoring-Dashboards. Angefangen habe ich in Hamburg mit der Digitalisierung operativer Prozesse im Hangar für die A321XLR.

Die übrige Zeit bin ich seit Januar offiziell nominierte AI Accelerator. Das heißt, ich baue selbst. RaiDAR ist ein KI-gestützter Plattformkatalog, den ich von Anfang an entwickelt habe und bis heute weiterentwickle, mit hybridem Retrieval und mit Quellenbelegen. SPARK ist ein Team aus elf spezialisierten Agenten, das einen vollständigen Delivery-Prozess über fünfzehn Stationen abbildet, mit einer expliziten menschlichen Freigabe an jeder Übergabe. Demnächst stelle ich das gruppenweit vor, als erste CIMPA-Mitarbeiterin in dieser Reihe.

Warum ich heute hier bin: Ich arbeite seit drei Jahren in einem Umfeld, in dem Nachvollziehbarkeit, Datenqualität und lange Produktlebenszyklen über den Erfolg entscheiden. Genau das sind die Bedingungen, unter denen KI im Verteidigungsbereich funktionieren muss. Carl Hase hat mich auf die Rolle aufmerksam gemacht und mich empfohlen.

ENGLISH, IF THEY SWITCH

I am a Data and AI Consultant based in Berlin. Since 2023 I have been with CIMPA, a Sopra Steria company, working on Airbus projects. I am originally from Guatemala and came to Germany in 2015 for my master's. My background is engineering, first chemical engineering in Guatemala, then environmental engineering in Lübeck. I moved into data through research, and because I prefer working with people and stakeholders over working in a lab, I moved into consulting via a data science bootcamp.

I hold two roles today. About seventy percent of my time I own data governance across the Airbus data platforms: a roadmap of more than forty initiatives, thirty of them delivered, plus data quality campaigns, governance frameworks and monitoring dashboards. I started in Hamburg digitalising operational processes in the hangar for the A321XLR.

The remaining time I have been a formally nominated AI Accelerator since January. That means I build. RaiDAR is an AI-powered platform catalogue I developed from scratch and still develop today, with hybrid retrieval and source citations. SPARK is a team of eleven specialised agents running a full delivery pipeline across fifteen stations, with an explicit human approval gate at every handover. I will be presenting it group-wide shortly, as the first CIMPA employee in that series.

Why I am here today: for three years I have worked in an environment where traceability, data quality and long product lifecycles decide whether something works. Those are exactly the conditions AI has to survive in defence. Carl Hase pointed me to this role and recommended me.

02 Hybrid retrieval, explained

The basic idea

Retrieval means: before the language model answers anything, a search happens first. The model does not invent the answer from its training. It is handed the relevant documents from your internal content and formulates the answer only from those. So the quality of the answer depends almost entirely on whether the search found the right passages.

And that is the whole point: there is no single search method that answers every kind of question well. That is why hybrid, meaning several search methods running in parallel.

The three routes, each with its weakness

METHOD	STRONG AT	WEAK AT
Lexical Classic keyword search, technically usually BM25 over an inverted index. Matches the actual word, character by character.	Exact names, system designations, abbreviations, numbers, rare terms. Type "EBAM" and it finds exactly EBAM.	Paraphrases. Searching "maintain part data" will not find a page that says "manage component master data".
Vector Each text chunk is turned by an embedding model into a vector, a series of numbers representing meaning. The query is embedded too, then the closest vectors are found, usually via cosine similarity.	Meaning rather than wording. "Maintain part data" and "manage component master data" sit close in vector space although no word matches.	Exactly what lexical is good at. With proper names, version numbers and abbreviations it returns something similar instead of the right thing. Dangerous failure mode: not nothing, but something plausible and wrong.
Graph Objects stored as nodes and edges rather than blocks of text: this platform belongs to that domain, this system feeds that one, this role is accountable.	Relationship and multi-step questions. "Which systems are connected to Skywise", "who is accountable for the data flowing into this platform".	Not a substitute for text search. It only knows what has been modelled as a relationship.

Why hybrid, and what grounding means

The weaknesses cancel each other out. All three are queried in parallel, each returns a ranked list, and those lists are merged into one. Only the merged result is passed to the model as context.

Source citations are two things in one word. First, the answer may come only from the retrieved material, not from the model's general knowledge and not from the open web. In English that is called grounding. Second, every statement shows which document it came from, so the user can look it up. That is the difference between a tool you trust and a tool you can verify. In a regulated environment only the second one counts. And when nothing suitable is found, the correct answer is "I have nothing on that in the content base", not an invented answer.

DIE FASSUNG FÜR DREISSIG SEKUNDEN

Bevor das Modell antwortet, wird gesucht, und ich nutze drei Suchwege parallel. Die lexikalische Suche findet exakte Begriffe, also Systemnamen und Abkürzungen. Die vektorbasierte findet die Bedeutung, also auch dann, wenn jemand die Sache anders nennt, als sie in der Dokumentation heißt. Die graphbasierte beantwortet Beziehungsfragen, etwa welche Systeme an einer Plattform hängen. Die Ergebnisse werden zusammengeführt und gehen als Kontext an das Modell. Die Antwort entsteht ausschließlich aus diesem Material und zeigt an, aus welchem Dokument sie stammt. Wenn nichts gefunden wird, sagt das System das, statt etwas zu erfinden.

ENGLISH

Before the model answers, a search runs, and I use three search routes in parallel. Lexical search finds exact terms, so system names and abbreviations. Vector search finds meaning, so it works even when someone calls a thing differently from how the documentation names it. Graph search answers relationship questions, for example which systems are attached to a platform. The results are merged and passed to the model as context. The answer is generated exclusively from that material and shows which document it came from. If nothing is found, the system says so instead of inventing something.

If Lilli Bruckschen digs deeper

HER QUESTION

WHAT TO SAY

How do you merge the three result lists?	The common method is Reciprocal Rank Fusion: it scores a hit by its position in each list rather than comparing raw scores, which are not on the same scale. Some systems weight instead, some add a reranker. Answer with what you actually did. If you simply weighted or concatenated, say that. With a PhD computer scientist the plain truth beats a term you cannot defend.
Where does the graph come from?	Do you build it from platform metadata, from an existing source, or by hand. Say what is true.
How do you measure whether retrieval is good?	If you have no evaluation set: so far I have worked with real user questions and manual review, a systematic evaluation set is the next step. Respectable answer, and it shows you know what is missing.
Why three and not two?	Because relationship questions would otherwise go unanswered. Your best argument, because it comes from the use case and not from a blog post.

THE ONE WARNING THAT MATTERS MOST

Only claim what you actually built. If one of the three routes is thin in your system, say so.

"Der Graph ist bisher schlank, im Wesentlichen die Beziehungen zwischen Plattformen und Domänen" is a good answer. An exaggerated answer will not survive two follow-up questions with her.

03 What Carl told you

3a. The Capgemini Public Defense page, four pillars

Their German Public Defense practice is built around four themes. These are their own words, worth knowing verbatim:

- Software Defined & Connected Defense. Their line: capability development today is no longer achieved through additional horsepower or explosive force, but above all through software. Plus 5G, open system architectures, agile methods.
- Cloud. Multi-cloud as the basis for resilient networking in the armed forces.
- Smart Administration. Data-driven decisions, removing media breaks, integrating systems end to end.
- Digital Continuity. Uninterrupted data flow across the entire product lifecycle, using digital twins and synchronised data sources.

PILLAR FOUR IS LITERALLY YOUR JOB

Digital Continuity across the product lifecycle with synchronised data sources is precisely what you do on the Airbus platforms, and CIMPA comes from Product Lifecycle Management. This is your strongest single overlap in their whole portfolio, stronger even than the agent story.

Two names from that page, in case they come up: Christopher Gaube, Country Lead Defense Germany, a former Bundeswehr officer with more than twenty years in defence. And Stefan Pollack, Director and Delivery Executive. Gaube is quite likely the person you would meet in a second round.

DER SATZ, DEN DU HEUTE SETZEN SOLLTEST

Als ich Ihre Public-Defense-Seite gelesen habe, ist mir vor allem die Säule Digital Continuity aufgefallen, also durchgängige Daten über den Produktlebenszyklus mit synchronisierten Quellen. Das ist ziemlich genau das, was ich seit drei Jahren mache. CIMPA kommt aus dem Product Lifecycle Management, und meine Arbeit ist die Datengrundlage darunter, also Stammdaten, Konfiguration und Nachvollziehbarkeit über Jahrzehnte. Digitale Zwillinge und Smart Administration stehen und fallen mit dieser Schicht.

ENGLISH

When I read your Public Defense page, the pillar that stood out to me was Digital Continuity, meaning continuous data across the product lifecycle with synchronised sources. That is almost exactly what I have been doing for three years. CIMPA comes from Product Lifecycle Management, and my work is the data foundation underneath it, so master data, configuration and traceability across decades. Digital twins and smart administration stand or fall with that layer.

3b. The acronyms: BWI and BAAINBw

What you heard as "WWI" is almost certainly BWI. BWI GmbH is the Bundeswehr's in-house IT system house, a federally owned company. More than 8,500 employees, 2.25 billion euro revenue in 2025, 16 major and over 135 smaller sites. They run more than 1.2 million IT systems and one of Europe's largest SAP landscapes. Three areas: administrative IT, deployment-near IT, and the digitalisation of the armed forces.

The decisive fact, from early September: BWI announced at its Industry Days that it plans to award more than ten billion euro in contracts to industry between 2027 and 2031, focused on highly available and secure IT systems, the digital battlefield, and command capability.

That is why this role is being filled now. Mentioning it shows you understand the market, not just the job ad.

"BBI" is most likely BAAINBw, the Federal Office for Bundeswehr Equipment, Information Technology and In-Service Support, based in Koblenz, the procurement authority. It could also be BMVg, the defence ministry. To be safe: say "BWI und die

Beschaffungsseite, also BAAINBw" rather than guessing an acronym. A wrong acronym is noticed instantly in this environment. A spelled-out description never is.

3c. Ravenstorm, and a serious warning

Airbus unveiled it at the ILA Berlin airshow in June 2026: the U760 Ravenstorm, an Uncrewed Collaborative Combat Aircraft, a loyal-wingman type combat drone, stealth-shaped, intended for air-to-surface precision strike, air-to-air defence and electronic warfare. Airbus says it will be available in the early 2030s.

The part that matters for you: autonomy runs on Airbus's own MARS Mission System, Multiplatform Autonomous Reconfigurable and Secure, with an AI-supported software core intended to scale across the whole drone family. That is exactly the territory of this role: AI as a capability inside a software-defined platform.

DO NOT BLUR THIS LINE

You work on the civil side of Airbus. A321XLR, EBAM, Skywise, Commercial Aircraft. Ravenstorm is Airbus Defence and Space, a different part of the group.

Say nothing that could sound as though you are involved with it. If she follows up and you have to walk it back, the damage to trust is larger than anything you gain. State the boundary yourself, first, and then say what genuinely interests you about it.

FALLS RAVENSTORM ZUR SPRACHE KOMMT

Ravenstorm habe ich verfolgt, seit Airbus es im Juni auf der ILA vorgestellt hat. Das ist Airbus Defence and Space, ich selbst arbeite auf der zivilen Seite, also Commercial Aircraft. Was mich daran interessiert, ist, dass die Autonomie über ein Missionssystem mit KI-Kern läuft, das über mehrere Plattformen hinweg skalieren soll. Das ist genau die Frage, die mich reizt: nicht ein Modell für einen Zweck, sondern eine KI-Fähigkeit, die über eine Systemfamilie hinweg trägt und trotzdem nachvollziehbar bleibt.

ENGLISH

I have followed Ravenstorm since Airbus presented it at the ILA in June. That is Airbus Defence and Space, I work on the civil side myself, Commercial Aircraft. What interests me about it is that the autonomy runs on a mission system with an AI core that is meant to scale across several platforms. That is exactly the question I find compelling: not one model for one purpose, but an AI capability that carries across a family of systems and still stays traceable.

Context, but do not open with it: Ravenstorm has gained importance because the Franco-German fighter programme within FCAS has run into difficulty. That is politically sensitive ground and you have no reason to hold a view on it. If they raise it, listen and ask a question.

3d. Why Carl sent you this

Read it this way: he is telling you the Defense unit works with BWI and with Airbus Defence. That points at a selling argument you have not been using.

You know the Airbus group from the inside. Its data platforms, its governance structures, how it works and how it talks. If Capgemini is working towards Airbus Defence and Space, someone who knows the Airbus data ecosystem is not a career changer. She is a shortcut.

EINMAL SAGEN, NICHT WIEDERHOLEN

Wenn Airbus Defence and Space zu Ihren Kunden gehört, bringe ich etwas mit, das man schwer nachlesen kann: Ich kenne die Datenplattformen und die Governance-Strukturen des Konzerns von innen und weiß, wie dort Entscheidungen zustande kommen. Das verkürzt die Einarbeitung erheblich.

ENGLISH

If Airbus Defence and Space is one of your clients, I bring something that is hard to read up on: I know the group's data platforms and governance structures from the inside, and I know how decisions get made there. That shortens onboarding considerably.

04 Your questions, updated

Pick four or five, not more. Good questions are the part of the conversation people remember. These two are now better than what was in the first brief:

AN FRANZISKA ROSENBAUM

Die BWI hat Anfang September Vergaben von über zehn Milliarden Euro für 2027 bis 2031 angekündigt. Wie positioniert sich Capgemini darauf, und wie verschiebt das Ihr Portfolio in den nächsten zwei Jahren?

ENGLISH

BWI announced in early September that it plans to award more than ten billion euro in contracts between 2027 and 2031. How is Capgemini positioning for that, and how does it shift your portfolio over the next two years?

AN BEIDE

Die vierte Säule auf Ihrer Seite, Digital Continuity, ist die, die meiner Arbeit am nächsten liegt. Wie konkret ist das heute in Projekten, und wie viel davon ist noch Zielbild?

ENGLISH

The fourth pillar on your page, Digital Continuity, is the one closest to my own work. How concrete is that in projects today, and how much of it is still a target picture?

AN LILLI BRUCKSCHEN

Wenn Sie auf die Vorhaben der letzten zwölf Monate schauen, woran scheitern KI-Initiativen in diesem Umfeld am häufigsten? An der Technik, an den Daten oder an der Abnahme?

ENGLISH

Looking at the last twelve months of work, where do AI initiatives most often fail in this environment? On the technology, on the data, or on acceptance and sign-off?

ZUR ROLLE · DIE BESTE FRAGE, HEBE SIE DIR FÜR DEN SCHLUSS AUF

Was müsste in den ersten sechs Monaten passieren, damit Sie sagen, die Besetzung war richtig?

ENGLISH

What would have to happen in the first six months for you to say this hire was the right one?

SELBSTVORSTELLUNG, VIER HÄKCHEN

- Wer ich bin · Was ich verantworte
- Was ich baue · Warum ich hier bin
- Neunzig Sekunden. Auf die Uhr schauen.
- Carl Hase im letzten Satz.

ZAHLEN

- 40+ Initiativen, 30 geliefert
- 11 Agenten, 15 Stationen, Freigabe an jeder
- 3 Retrieval-Wege
- seit 2023 CIMPA, seit Jan 2026 AI Accelerator

RETRIEVAL IN EINEM SATZ

Lexikalisch findet exakte Namen. Vektorbasiert findet Bedeutung. Graphbasiert findet Beziehungen. Zusammengeführt, geerdet im internen Bestand, mit Quellenangabe. Nichts gefunden heißt: nichts gefunden.

NUR SAGEN, WAS DU GEBAUT HAST

Wenn der Graph schlank ist, sag das. Ehrlichkeit hält jede Nachfrage aus, Übertreibung nicht zwei.

DEINE SÄULE

Digital Continuity. Durchgängige Daten über den Produktlebenszyklus, synchronisierte Quellen, digitale Zwillinge. Das ist wörtlich dein Beruf. Einmal platzieren.

DIE VIER SÄULEN

- Software Defined & Connected Defense
- Cloud
- Smart Administration
- Digital Continuity

MARKTWSISSEN

- BWI: IT-Systemhaus der Bundeswehr, 8.500 Mitarbeitende
- BWI vergibt 2027 bis 2031 über 10 Mrd. an die Industrie
- BAAINBw, Koblenz, Beschaffung
- Ravenstorm U760: Airbus Defence and Space, nicht meine Seite

ROTE LINIEN

- Keine internen Airbus-Details
- Nicht behaupten: Embedded, Zulassung, CV in Produktion
- Keine Hobbys, keine Familie
- Kein Wort gegen CIMPA

ZUM SCHLUSS

Sagen, dass du die Rolle willst. Und fragen: Was müsste in sechs Monaten passiert sein, damit die Besetzung richtig war?